



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Ann Classical Academy

School Website: <https://stannclassical.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St Ann Classical Academy (Raritan, NJ) presents a robust Catholic, classical education anchored in the Trivium and Quadrivium, a commitment to wonder, virtue, and the integration of faith with reason. Public materials from the school emphasize liturgical life, daily prayer, Catholic identity, and a curriculum designed to cultivate wisdom, virtue, and human flourishing through the liberal arts. Evidence from the school's own site highlights the seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), the integration of sacred liturgy into school life, and a pedagogy that blends contemplative elements with Socratic/rigorous inquiry in appropriate stages. Based on a keyword analysis against the classical school rubric, the overall assessment is CLASSICAL, with Element 4 (Pedagogy) representing a somewhat less explicit alignment relative to the strongest signals in the other areas. The school's signs of classical orientation are strong in religious/moral formation, curriculum, faculty, and family/community engagement, consistent with a classical-Catholic profile.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL**
 - Evidence: Strong Catholic identity, daily prayer, liturgy and sacraments, and formation in faith together with reason; references to God's order and divine providence in learning; emphasis on Christian discipleship and sacred traditions.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include Catholic theology, liturgy, sacraments, reverence, wonder, logos, and sacred tradition; little to no negative signals observed in public materials.
 - Why this rating: The school explicitly grounds education in a transcendent moral order and Catholic theology, aligning with transcendental moral realism and liturgical/community practices in the classical framework.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL**
 - Evidence: Emphasis on formation of character, virtue, wisdom, and the unity of truth, goodness, and beauty; aim to form the whole person, not merely prepare for work.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, scholé, contemplation, and classical heritage; essentially no evidence of a work- or job-prep orientation in public materials.
 - Why this rating: The materials frame education as paideia—formation of the person toward human excellence and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty.
- **Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL**
 - Evidence: Explicit reference to the liberal arts (Trivium and Quadrivium), seven liberal arts, and integration of history, literature, and philosophy; attention to Great Books / primary sources in the canon; emphasis on wonder and integrated learning across disciplines.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include liberal arts, Trivium, Quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, primary sources, Western civilization, history, geography, and sacred

arts; negative keywords (e.g., education replaced by social studies terminology or STEM-first framing) are not evident in the site materials.

- Why this rating: The curricular signals align strongly with classical expectations (grammar/logic/rhetoric; history as a throughline; Great Books; integration and wonder).
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The site signals a mix of contemplative/restful approaches and memory-based practices (e.g., singing, recitation, and liturgical integration); there are indications of upper-school discourse and rhetoric training, and a liturgical/musical dimension (Schola Cantorum). Public materials also describe integration of faith and reason across subjects.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include Socratic-style discussion, narration/recitation, chanting, memory-work, and upper-school rhetoric; there are clear signals of contemplative/restful elements (scholé, wonder). Negative signals are limited but the explicit articulation of full, routine Socratic seminars or formal high-school seminars/debates is less consistently documented in the public materials.
- Why this rating: The pedagogy blends classical methods (narration, recitation, memory, liturgical integration) with some modern practices, but explicit, consistent articulation of full Socratic seminars across grades and a fully developed upper-level seminar/debate program is not uniformly visible in the public content. This yields a CLASSICAL orientation with partial “Socratic” signaling, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Faculty pages and testimonials describe teachers as mentors and living examples of virtuous learning; there is a sense of a “living curriculum” and a community of knowledgeable, virtuous educators; a clear emphasis on character formation and moral exemplars.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include master/teacher as mentor, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, and moral exemplars; no strong negative signals observed in public materials.
- Why this rating: The public materials portray faculty as role models and the core of the school’s mission, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The school emphasizes a mission-driven Catholic community with family involvement and liturgical life; events, feasts, and parish collaboration are highlighted (e.g., Eucharistic Holy Hours, liturgical life, schola, community celebrations). There is active student-family participation and a culture of shared formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, parent formation, family liturgy, open campus, and liturgical year events; the lexicon signals such family partnership signals as core to classical formation. Negative signals are not evident in the materials.
- Why this rating: The public materials present parents as engaged co-participants in formation, consistent with the classical model’s emphasis on a family-centered, communal education.

Overall Assessment

- Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL
- The school demonstrates strong alignment with classical education across Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Curriculum, and Faculty, with robust signals in Purpose and Goal, and a solid but slightly more blended Pedagogy signal (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Element 4). Parents & Community engagement aligns with classical expectations. The combination yields an overall CLASSICAL classification with a needle-move potential focused on pedagogy (Element 4).

What Would Move the Needle



- Make upper-grade Socratic seminars and formal debates a more explicit and consistently communicated component of the pedagogy, with documented rubrics and outcomes across grades.
- More explicit articulation of the Great Books / Great Conversation framework within the curriculum notes on the site (e.g., direct references to Great Books lists and primary sources in core courses beyond history).
- Strengthen explicit parent formation offerings and documented partnerships with families as co-educators (e.g., book studies, parent sessions, and home-education alignments) with public-facing examples and schedules.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.